

→ ~/resume whoami

Sarah Sherriff

// target_role: Head of People & Operations, Startups

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9+ YEARS · PEOPLE / TALENT / OPS

AI TRANSFORMATION LEAD

readme.md

/**

* Hands-on People & Operations leader with 9+ years building the human

* and operational infrastructure behind fast-growing startups.

*/

I build People functions from 0 → 1: org design, technical hiring, culture, comp, compliance, and the systems that hold up under startup pace. I've run full-cycle recruiting through 2x headcount growth (50 → 100 employees in 12 months), and I currently own AI transformation end-to-end — rolling out tooling, playbooks, and enablement across Engineering, GTM, Ops, and People.

I operate like an engineer: instrument the system, automate the manual work, ship measurable outcomes. I partner directly with founders and engineering leadership to make sure People & Ops strategy keeps pace with the business — not just the headcount plan.

stats.json

9+

years in People, Talent
& Ops

2x

headcount growth led
(50-100 in 12mo)

120+

hires delivered across
7 functions

3

AI tools deployed org-
wide

4

functions covered in AI
rollout

2

direct reports led (US
/ NZ)

30%

female rep. in
engineering achieved

50%

female rep. in support
engineering

experience/



Factor House

Apr 2025 – Present · 1 yr 5 mos

{ Head of People & Operations }

Apr 2025 – Present

```
// Lead People & Operations strategy at Factor House, aligning People Ops, hiring, and culture initiatives directly with company OKRs and business priorities.
// Built the People function from 0 → 1: engagement programs, feedback loops, and company-wide rituals (All Hands, 1:1s, standups) that drove retention.
// Design and maintain HR policy and compliance frameworks across every jurisdiction the company employs in – standardising global contracts and managing Remote (EOR) for international employment.
// Own end-to-end business restructures – partnering directly with external lawyers and finance to manage process, risk, and communications.
// Deployed the company's AI tooling stack (Claude Code, Claude Cowork) – shipped internal playbooks, prompt libraries, and usage guardrails now used org-wide.
// Built the AI literacy & learning program: onboarding, weekly office hours, and role-specific workshops that lifted every team's baseline capability.
// Re-engineered hiring as a system – instrumented the full funnel, automated manual workflows, and shipped live talent analytics dashboards that drive data-informed people decisions for leadership.
// Partner directly with founders and senior leadership on org design and headcount planning, influencing stakeholders through periods of structural change.
// Coach managers and senior leaders 1:1 on leadership development and performance management, building high-performing teams.
// Established and play a key role on the company's leadership team, delivering fortnightly updates on people initiatives and operational improvements.
```

stack: [Claude Code](#) [Claude Cowork](#) [Cursor](#) [Notion](#) [Hibob](#) [Ashby](#) [Linear](#) [LinkedIn Recruiter](#) [Juicebox](#) [Certn](#) [Remote](#) [Slack](#)



Buildkite

Jan 2021 – Feb 2025 · 4 yrs 1 mo

{ Global Talent Acquisition Manager }

Dec 2022 – Feb 2025

```
// Grew and led a distributed team of 2 Senior Talent Acquisition Partners across the US and New Zealand.
// Led the end-to-end ATS migration Lever → Greenhouse with zero disruption to live pipelines.
// Rolled out GoodTime scheduling – cut manual interview-coordination overhead across the hiring org.
// Built an AI notetaker + feedback model giving interviewers faster, more structured, more accurate feedback.
// Built a recurring hiring-metrics reporting cadence for leadership and recruiters; presented at Leadership QBRs.
// Maintained SOC2 compliance across the People function through every audit cycle.
// Built a global comp & benefits structure from scratch using Pave.
// Automated system onboarding and owned data hygiene across the People tech stack.
```

stack: [Greenhouse](#) [GoodTime](#) [Notion](#) [Hibob](#) [LinkedIn Recruiter](#) [Canva](#) [Remote.com](#) [Slack](#) [Basecamp](#) [GitHub](#) [Linear](#)

{ Founding Talent Acquisition Partner }

Jan 2021 – Dec 2022

```
// First TA hire at Buildkite – owned end-to-end global recruitment across Engineering, Product, Sales, Marketing, Support, Finance, and Operations.
// Designed Buildkite's technical interview process from scratch, including engineering hiring loops.
// Introduced Buildkite's first hiring committee to remove bias from hiring decisions.
// Led implementation of Buildkite's first core HR system (Hibob).
```

// IMPACT

```
// Hired 120+ employees across 7 functions in under 2 years.
// Helped Buildkite double headcount – 50 → 100 employees – in 12 months (100% YoY growth).
// Grew female representation in software engineering to 30%.
// Grew female representation in global support engineering to 50%.
```

stack: [Lever](#) [LinkedIn Recruiter](#) [Hibob](#) [Figma](#) [Asana](#) [Basecamp](#) [Zoom](#) [Google Suite](#)

{ Principal Recruitment Partner }

Jun 2021 – Dec 2021

Greater Melbourne Area · Technology | Financial Services

// Established and grew senior stakeholder relationships to align recruitment strategy with hiring managers' evolving needs across Technology and Financial Services clients.

// Led end-to-end permanent recruitment for technology roles – sourcing, shortlisting, interviewing, and offer negotiation.

// Shared market insights and salary benchmarking with hiring managers to speed up decision-making and improve engagement.

// Cultivated external commercial partnerships to expand Hays' recruitment capability and reach in the Melbourne technology market.

stack: OneTouch LinkedIn Recruiter Seek Search Sales Navigator

{ Systems Expert / Systems Trainer }

Jun 2019 – Dec 2021

Melbourne, Victoria, Australia

// Acted as the go-to systems expert across Hays' internal database, Sales Navigator, LinkedIn Recruiter, and Seek Search.

// Provided coaching to new team members on the internal database, driving rapid adoption and high productivity across job registration, placements, and other critical processes.

// Designed and delivered systems training sessions (1:1s and group workshops) that lifted platform proficiency across the team.

// Partnered with the wider team to troubleshoot system issues and continuously improve recruitment workflows.

stack: OneTouch LinkedIn Recruiter Seek Search Sales Navigator

{ Senior Recruitment Partner }

Jul 2017 – Jun 2019

Melbourne · Technology | Financial Services

// Managed a full desk of permanent technology and financial services placements end-to-end: briefing, sourcing, shortlisting, interviewing, and offer negotiation.

// Built and maintained long-term relationships with clients and candidates across the Melbourne technology market.

// Delivered consultative recruitment solutions, combining market insight with a high-touch candidate and client experience.

// Represented Hays at industry events (Girls in Tech, YOW, MeetUps) to build community presence and pipeline.

// Ensured full compliance with employment law and Hays' quality standards throughout the recruitment lifecycle.

stack: OneTouch LinkedIn Recruiter Seek Search Sales Navigator

media.log

{ BOLD – Ep. 2: Hiring & Scaling }

Featured Panelist

LaunchVic · "Building the Right Team at Every Stage"

// Featured panelist on LaunchVic's BOLD roundtable series, alongside leaders from JET Charge, Fortiro, and Edrolo.

// Discussed early-stage hiring philosophy, performance rituals, leadership transitions, and AI adoption in scaling startups.

watch: launchvic.org/resources/bold-ep2-hiring-and-scaling

skills.yaml

strategic_leadership:

- Org design & headcount planning

- Executive & founder partnership

- Budget & vendor management

- Performance mgmt & leadership coaching

people_ops_systems:

- HRIS & ATS architecture

- System migrations

compliance_risk:

- SOC2 compliance

- Global employment law

- EOR & global employment (Remote)

- Contract standardisation

culture_engagement:

- Engagement programs & rituals

- DEI&B strategy

- Workflow & process automation
 - Talent analytics & dashboards
 - Data hygiene & governance
- talent_acquisition:
- Full-cycle technical recruitment
 - Engineering interview design
 - Hiring committees (anti-bias)
 - Employer branding
- ai_automation:
- Change management
 - AI adoption & transformation strategy
 - LLM tooling (Claude Code, Cowork, Cursor)
 - Prompt design & enablement
 - Org-wide AI literacy programs

education.md

Bachelor of Business Administration	2011
Bond University • Leadership & Entrepreneurship	
Product Management	2023
RMIT	